



Space travel



People have always wanted to know about space. For years scientists could only look up into the sky. Today, they can send up rockets to investigate.

Space shuttle

Astronauts inside the space shuttle are blasted into space on the back of a rocket.

Shuttle

Main fuel tank

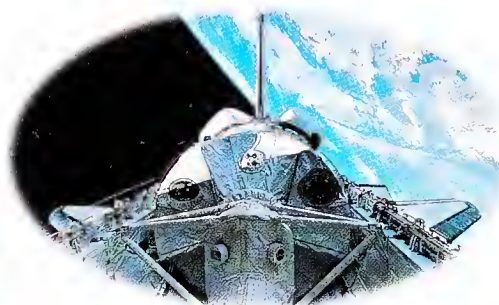
Extra fuel tanks for takeoff

Rocket fuel burning



Working in space

Astronauts leave the shuttle to do experiments.



Space orbit

Out in space, the rocket drops away from the shuttle, which then slowly orbits, or circles, the Earth.



Landing

On its return from space, the shuttle flies through the Earth's atmosphere and lands just like an ordinary plane.

Life in space



People float around in space because there is no gravity to hold them down.

Space suits are special protective outfits. They help astronauts breathe in space.



Space food is different than normal food – it is dried to make it last.



Viewing space

Satellite dishes on Earth collect information and pictures from satellites in space.



Satellites orbit in space. They send information back to Earth.



Space probes are sent into space to explore other planets.

Did you know?

The *Saturn V* rocket had the most powerful engine ever. It used 3.3 tons (3 tonnes) of fuel per second!

